Achieving Academic Excellence Style Guide and Graphics

For Internal Use: This living guide helps DPI and SBE staff access Strategic Plan design elements for internal documents, PowerPoints, and conference or training presentations. To ensure consistency across the agency, please coordinate with the Communications and Graphics teams for all external communications as official guidance develops. Together, let's build a strong, sustainable foundation for our Eight Pillars!

External communications: As we develop agency-wide plans, external Strategic Plan communications should be managed or reviewed by the Office of Communications. Please email communications@dpi.nc.gov for review.

Graphics and templates: Most designed materials and document templates for external use should be designed by the agency's graphic design team. Email branding@dpi.nc.gov for requests or approvals. There is no charge for graphics related to the Strategic Plan, but allow time for project review, approval, and scheduling in the job queue. A PowerPoint & Slides file with this art also exists in SharePoint and Google Drive.

NCDPI Style Guide: All NCDPI Style Guide and Color Guide standards apply to Strategic Plan materials, except where specified in this document.

DO:

- Use **Pillar icons** (as provided) on internal and external materials that connect your work to specific Pillars.
- Use the **Achieving Educational Excellence logos** and **8 Pillar graphics** (as provided) to introduce the Plan as a part of your work.
- Share examples of how you're using graphics and templates—this helps us improve art, templates, and guidelines.
- Maintain clear space around graphics:
    - Logos: ~¼" (depending on scale)
    - Icons: at least ⅛" (preferably ¼")
- Contact branding@dpi.nc.gov for:
    - Different file types (~4 hrs)
    - Artwork modifications (1-4 days)
    - Promotional materials/graphics (1-2 weeks)
    - Word or Google templates for sets of materials about the Plan (2-4 weeks)

DO NOT:

- **Screenshot & repurpose graphics.** Instead, copy/paste from this document, or use provided PNG files on SharePoint or the Google NCDPI Shared Drive. Email branding for repurposing.
- Alter logos, icons or graphics in any way, including:
    - Editing colors
    - Adding effects (e.g., drop shadows, beveling)
    - Distorting or skewing (always scale proportionally using the Shift key)
    - Removing Pillar icons from circles
- Create your own Pillar or Plan graphics - Please request all new art from Graphics
- Use logo or icons as watermarks or repeated background patterns.
- Add borders or design or text elements to logos, icons, or graphics.

Strategic Plan Logos

See page 1 for use guidelines. The art in this document may be copy/pasted to other Google products. PNGs can also be found on SharePoint or the Google NCDPI Shared Drive.

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for North Carolina Public Schools

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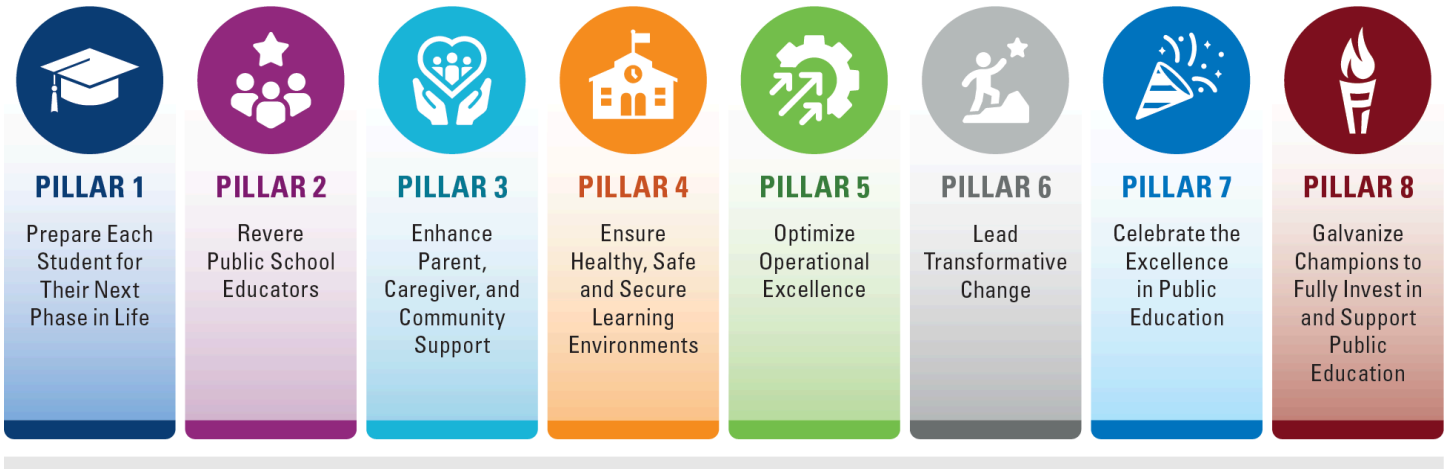
Eight Pillars Art

Please do not alter text or stretch this art. If you need size alterations, contact branding@dpi.nc.gov.

Use the versions with full text sparingly. Do not use smaller than this image (7.5” width). Even at this size, the text is not technically accessible and is better suited for full-width landscape or in PowerPoints. If you simply want a Pillars graphic, use the above version without full text.



We have individual pillars saved in the Strategic Plan PPT Graphics file for PPT pages specifically about each pillar. For most other uses, represent the pillars with the icon only.

If you need a graphic of the individual gradient pillars, contact branding@dpi.nc.gov with the required size and file type. Do not stretch or recreate the pillars.

Strategic Plan Pillar Icons

PILLAR 1	PILLAR 2	PILLAR 3
PILLAR 4	**PILLAR 5**	**PILLAR 6**
PILLAR 7	**PILLAR 8**	

Strategic Plan Pillar Icons + Number

PILLAR 1	PILLAR 2
PILLAR 3	PILLAR 4
PILLAR 5	PILLAR 6
PILLAR 7	PILLAR 8

Strategic Plan Pillar Icons + Full Text

Prepare Each Student for Their Next Phase in Life	Revere Public School Educators
Enhance Parent, Caregiver, and Community Support	Ensure Healthy, Safe and Secure Learning Environments
Optimize Operational Excellence	Lead Transformative Change
Celebrate the Excellence in Public Education	Galvanize Champions to Fully Invest in and Support Public Education

Pillar Colors for the Achieving Academic Excellence Strategic Plan

*** The colors listed for Pillars 7 and 8 should exclusively be used in reference to those pillars of the Strategic Plan.** Pillar 7 Blue and Pillar 8 Burgundy should not be used on any other NCDPI branded materials, they are not NCDPI accent colors. Please refer to the NCDPI Color Guide.

PILLARS	Icon Color	Large Text *Regular text 18pt & above or Bold text 14pt & above*	Small Text *Regular text below 18pt or Bold text below 14pt*	15% Background *For text on tinted blocks. There should not be a need for other screens.*
Pillar 1	DPI Blue 003A70	DPI Blue 003A70	DPI Blue 003A70	D9E4F1
Pillar 2	DPI Purple 922880	Medium Purple 801E70	Dark Purple 6E1360	EFDFEC
Pillar 3	DPI Aqua 29B5D9	Medium Aqua 077890	Dark Aqua 006174	DFF4F9
Pillar 4	Orange FF9015	Medium Orange C75128	Dark Orange 943E20	FFEEDC
Pillar 5	Green 74C04B	Medium Green 3D803F	Dark Green 2F6230	EAF6E4
Pillar 6	Gray B7B9BB	Medium Gray 6B6F70	Dark Gray 525A60	F4F4F5
Pillar 7	Blue * 0077BF	Medium Blue * 0063A2	Medium Blue * 0063A2	D4EFFC
Pillar 8	Burgundy * 801323	Burgundy * 801323	Burgundy * 801323	ECDCDE